

HOUSE No. 2397**The Commonwealth of Massachusetts**

PRESENTED BY:

Marjorie C. Decker*To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:*

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act establishing a nursing workforce center.

PETITION OF:

NAME:	DISTRICT/ADDRESS:	DATE ADDED:
<i>Marjorie C. Decker</i>	<i>25th Middlesex</i>	<i>1/16/2025</i>
<i>Daniel Cahill</i>	<i>10th Essex</i>	<i>2/13/2025</i>
<i>John Francis Moran</i>	<i>9th Suffolk</i>	<i>2/13/2025</i>
<i>Bruce E. Tarr</i>	<i>First Essex and Middlesex</i>	<i>6/11/2025</i>
<i>Estela A. Reyes</i>	<i>4th Essex</i>	<i>5/28/2025</i>
<i>Patrick Joseph Kearney</i>	<i>4th Plymouth</i>	<i>9/16/2025</i>
<i>Carmine Lawrence Gentile</i>	<i>13th Middlesex</i>	<i>9/30/2025</i>
<i>Natalie M. Higgins</i>	<i>4th Worcester</i>	<i>9/30/2025</i>
<i>Adrian C. Madaro</i>	<i>1st Suffolk</i>	<i>10/2/2025</i>
<i>Homar Gómez</i>	<i>2nd Hampshire</i>	<i>10/2/2025</i>
<i>David Allen Robertson</i>	<i>19th Middlesex</i>	<i>10/2/2025</i>
<i>James C. Arena-DeRosa</i>	<i>8th Middlesex</i>	<i>10/2/2025</i>
<i>William F. MacGregor</i>	<i>10th Suffolk</i>	<i>10/2/2025</i>

HOUSE No. 2397

By Representative Decker of Cambridge, a petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 2397) of Marjorie C. Decker, Daniel Cahill and John Francis Moran relative to establishing a nursing workforce center at the University of Massachusetts medical school. Public Health.

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

An Act establishing a nursing workforce center.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1 SECTION 1. Chapter 75 of the General Laws, as appearing in the 2024 Official Edition,
2 is hereby amended by inserting after section 36E the following section: –

3 Section 36F. There shall be at the University of Massachusetts medical school in
4 Worcester a nursing workforce center, formerly known as the Nursing Council on Workforce
5 Sustainability, herein the Nursing Workforce Center. The purpose of the Center shall be to gather
6 data, research, provide analysis to advise policy leaders on how to address the current and future
7 nursing workforce needs of nurses and others who support nursing care, and provide
8 recommendations to advance nursing science and practice in the commonwealth. The Center
9 shall be administered by an executive director who shall be appointed by the dean of the
10 University of Massachusetts medical school. The Center shall be subject to the direction and
11 oversight of the executive office of health and human Services.

12 The Center shall:

(a) Convene a diverse group of key stakeholders including nurses, health care providers, business and industry leaders, consumers, state agencies, legislators and educators to collaborate on strategies to improve the nursing workforce and speak with one voice on issues impacting the nursing workforce.

(b) Conduct research on best practices and quality patient outcomes across settings.

(c) Prepare and disseminate written reports and recommendations regarding the current and future status and trends of the nursing workforce.

(d) Research, analyze and report data related to the recruitment and retention of the nursing workforce.

(e) Develop and implement strategies to recruit and retain nurses in the commonwealth.

(f) Recommend systemic changes to the nursing workforce pipeline.

(g) Disseminate the results of the reviews and make recommendations to the joint committee on public health, the joint committee on higher education, the house and senate committee on ways and means, the department of public health, health care stakeholders, consumers and other interested parties.

(h) Foster collaboration among members of the health care community to achieve policy consensus, promote diversity across the profession and within the health care workforce, and enhance the knowledge of nursing practice.

32 (i) Encourage initiatives to support nursing excellence through innovative strategies
33 such as recognition programs, incentives for professional growth, and activities that enhance the
34 visibility and positive perception of the nursing profession across the commonwealth.

35 (j) Prepare and disseminate an annual report on the state of the nursing workforce in
36 the commonwealth and the work of the Center.

37 (k) Provide consultation, technical assistance and information related to nursing
38 resources within and outside of the commonwealth and serve as a clearinghouse on nursing
39 practice and nursing workforce data.

40 (l) Examine and engage in other matters deemed appropriate by the executive office
41 of health and human services.